

People Data Retention Standard

Internal control reference OP-RET-26-0818 | Reviewed 2026-08-18

Purpose and scope

This synthetic internal standard defines baseline retention controls for People Operations records. It supports orderly review and disposal. It is not legal advice and does not replace applicable review.

Control principles

- Retain only the record category and period needed for the stated operational control.
- Restrict access to approved People Operations roles and use the approved retention repository.
- Document a review before disposal, transfer, or exception handling.

Approved retention periods

Unsuccessful candidate records	12 months after requisition closure
Interview working notes	6 months
Offer approvals and accepted offer records	7 years
Aggregate survey outputs	3 years

Applies to synthetic Orchid People operational records only. No individual identifiers are required for this control.

Control operation

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1. Review trigger

- Review record sets after requisition closure, at offboarding transfer, or at the scheduled control review.
- Confirm the category, repository location, and retention period before any disposition.

2. Disposition

- After the retention period, record the outcome as secure disposal, approved transfer, or documented exception.
- Keep interview working notes separate from accepted-offer approval records when their periods differ.

3. Evidence

- Use role labels and synthetic reference codes in control evidence.
- Do not place names, contact details, candidate IDs, employee IDs, or signatures in this standard.

4. Ownership

- People Operations Records Coordinator: conducts control review.
- Recruiting Operations Lead: confirms recruiting-record classification.

Control note

Retention values are internal synthetic policy values and are not legal advice.